

We read the data file as a string, and use `json.loads()` to convert the string representation of the file to a Python object ❶. This is the same approach we used in Chapter 10. In this case, the entire dataset is converted to a single dictionary, which we assign to `all_eq_data`. We then define a new path where we can write this same data in a more readable format ❷. The `json.dumps()` function that you saw in Chapter 10 can take an optional `indent` argument ❸, which tells it how much to indent nested elements in the data structure.

When you look in your `eq_data` directory and open the file `readable_eq_data.json`, here's the first part of what you'll see:

```
readable_eq {
_data.json  "type": "FeatureCollection",
❶  "metadata": {
    "generated": 1649052296000,
    "url": "https://earthquake.usgs.gov/earthquakes/.../1.0_day.geojson",
    "title": "USGS Magnitude 1.0+ Earthquakes, Past Day",
    "status": 200,
    "api": "1.10.3",
    "count": 160
  },
❷  "features": [
    --snip--
  ]
}
```

The first part of the file includes a section with the key `"metadata"` ❶. This tells us when the data file was generated and where we can find the data online. It also gives us a human-readable title and the number of earthquakes included in this file. In this 24-hour period, 160 earthquakes were recorded.

This GeoJSON file has a structure that's helpful for location-based data. The information is stored in a list associated with the key `"features"` ❷. Because this file contains earthquake data, the data is in list form where every item in the list corresponds to a single earthquake. This structure might look confusing, but it's quite powerful. It allows geologists to store as much information as they need to in a dictionary about each earthquake, and then stuff all those dictionaries into one big list.

Let's look at a dictionary representing a single earthquake:

```
readable_eq --snip--
_data.json  {
❶  "type": "Feature",
    "properties": {
      "mag": 1.6,
      --snip--
❷  "title": "M 1.6 - 27 km NNW of Susitna, Alaska"
    },
❸  "geometry": {
    "type": "Point",
    "coordinates": [
❹  -150.7585,
❺  61.7591,
    56.3
    ]
  }
}
```
